

DigiVue DG-210 2.1 MP Camera

When price matters

The DG-210 features 2.1 megapixels, 3X optical and 2X digital zoom, and a 16 MB Compact Flash memory card.

The camera looks rather bulky. There are several incon-

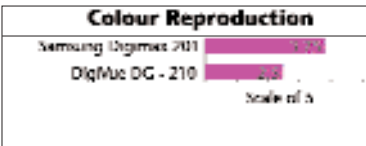


veniences that are apparent: you need to press the shutter button for about two seconds, and wait for a sound before the image gets clicked. The flash takes over three seconds to charge. The lens moves in and out very slowly, making it difficult to capture a moving object and refocus on the fly. The images we clicked were dark, both indoors and outdoors. Colours such as

orange were too bright, and green, too dark.

The camera is targeted at photo studios, and so comes with Photoshop 5 LE, which can be used to generate multiple passport size images. The DG-210 allows exposure settings from +2EV to -2EV in steps of 0.5EV. Regular users need to have knowledge of how to adjust this in different conditions for decent photographs.

At Rs 10,000, the camera is cheap, and will appeal to those migrating from film to digital cameras. However, we recommend spending a few thousands more for a better camera.



SPECIFICATIONS

2.1 megapixels, 3X optical zoom, 2X digital zoom, 16 MB CF card, four AA battery

Price: Rs 10,000
Contact: Monarch Video Vision
Phone: 022-22619022
Fax: 022-22618706
E-mail: viren@bom2.vsnl.net.in
Web site: www.monarchvision.com

Dragon NaturallySpeaking 7 Professional

Hands-free typing

This is the latest version of the popular software. There's a new Vocabulary Optimiser, which analyses the documents on your machine, to understand your writing habits. The provided handbook explains all valid voice commands, such as "start Internet Explorer", "click control menu", etc.



The software provides good functionalities, such as integration with Word, Internet Explorer, playback of dictations, voice control of Windows, customisable vocabularies, and more. There's support for additional input devices such as a digital recorder, Pocket PC, cordless microphone, etc.

The software provides a set of APIs so that

developers can extend the existing functionality.

On the performance front, the software handles voice commands exceedingly well, but when it comes to dictation, it doesn't get every word right. This performance lag is only for a short while, though. However, there are times when the software doesn't understand a word, even after one repeats it as many as four or five times.

This professional version costs Rs 44,995—consider it only if your workload is very large.

Price: Rs 44,995
Contact: ScanSoft International
Phone: 011-26207477
Fax: 011-26207495
E-mail: sameer.dania@scansoft.com
Web site: www.scansoft.com

SPECIFICATIONS

Intel Pentium III 500 MHz or equivalent processor, 256 MB RAM, 300 MB hard disk space, Microsoft Windows 98, Me, XP, 2000, 95C or NT4, with SP-6 or greater, Creative Labs Sound Blaster 16 or equivalent sound card supporting 16-bit recording, Microsoft Internet Explorer 5 or higher, CD-ROM drive, ScanSoft-approved noise-cancelling headset microphone (included), speakers (for playback of recorded speech and for text-to-speech features)

Dragon Naturally Speaking 7 Professional B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶

AverMagic Pro Plus

Magician at work

AverMagic Pro Plus is an image-editing tool that lets you retouch old or damaged images, revive them, do digital mixing, create visiting cards and so on. Using the software, you can turn black and white images to colour; you can define the skin tone in photographs, and even smoothen wrinkles.

The digital mixing feature is most commonly used in wedding albums. The process requires patience, though. Text can be added for effect. There are several pre-defined templates that allow you to quickly create frames for the front of albums, select a canvas with a texture of choice, place objects such as flowers into your photographs, and so on.

The features this software offers are all there in Photo-



shop; however, AverMagic Pro has been specifically developed for tasks such as the ones above, and the learning curve is therefore reduced.

It is worth its price of Rs 3,750 as it is customised to do a niche job, and do it more efficiently.

SPECIFICATIONS

Windows XP or 2000, PII or above processor, 64 MB or more of RAM, 2X or a faster CD-ROM drive, 15 MB hard disk space, SVGA video card

Price: Rs 3,750
Contact: Aver Software Technologies Ltd
Phone: 022-26732955
Fax: 022-26732956
Web site: www.avermagic.com

AverMagic Pro Plus B+	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Ease of use	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶▶